

Week 2 Writing Workshop

CFAN 3091V | Topic Funnel and Diagnostic Revision

Name: _____

Date: September 14, 2026

Submit: Hand in this worksheet at the end of class. Hand in the original Freewrite separately as Milestone 1.

Part 1. Topic Funnel

Worked example from Davis (2010)

1. **Broad domain:** weed management in no-till soybean
2. **Focused problem:** whether a roller-crimper can help suppress weeds with less reliance on herbicides without increasing soybean yield loss
3. **Comparison:** roller-crimper versus chemical burndown, across cover crops and postemergence glyphosate rates
4. **Testable claim:** in no-till soybean following cereal rye, roller-crimping will reduce surviving weed biomass without greater weed-interference yield loss than chemical burndown

Partner Practice

Choose one: calf health, food storage, pollinator habitat, household adoption of energy upgrades, music practice, or historical newspaper coverage.

Domain: _____

Focused problem:

Comparison:

Testable claim:

Your Topic Funnel

Use material from your Freewrite. A comparison may involve treatments, exposures, cases, groups, texts, time periods, policies, or explanations.

1. **Broad domain:**

2. **Focused problem:**

3. **What will you compare or relate?**

4. **Write one claim that could be checked and could turn out to be wrong:**

Partner test: What would you have to observe, measure, read, or compare to decide whether the claim holds?

Part 2. Diagnostic Revision

Select one paragraph from your Freewrite. Mark directly on the Freewrite, then use this page to revise. The Freewrite was graded for exploratory participation, not polish. This exercise has a different standard.

Diagnose Before Revising

Mark each item you can locate in the original paragraph. If a part is missing, mark where a reader would need it.

- | | | |
|-------------------------------------|--|---|
| ☐ main claim | ☐ evidence or example | ☐ reasoning that connects them |
| ☐ vague term | ☐ unsupported certainty | ☐ unnecessary wording |

What exactly happened or what exactly do you mean?

Compared with what, or in relation to what?

Under which conditions, and where does the claim stop?

Revised Paragraph

Revise for precision, clarity, and appropriate qualification without changing the underlying meaning.

Revision Decision

Which exact change most improved the paragraph, and why?

Instructor Check

- ☐ Satisfactory ☐ Not Yet Satisfactory

Brief feedback:
